Chapter 21

Your Globalizing World

responsible citizen a member of society who accepts and embraces a duty or obligation to that society

global citizenship the quality of being an aware, contributing member of society, especially in regard to global issues

Key Terms

responsible citizen
global citizenship
boycott
buycott
petition
ethical

Chapter Focus

Should I, as a citizen, respond to globalization? To respond to this Main Issue so far in Part 4, you have been informing yourself—one basis for becoming a **responsible citizen**.

At this point, you can start to think about what action you might want to take. The task may seem daunting at first. After all, the world's big governments and big organizations have not been able to solve global problems. You're just one person; unless you are a superstar, what effect can you possibly have on the world stage?

In fact, there is much that you can do to respond. It all starts at home, when you make choices about how you live your life, what is important to you, the career you will follow, and the ways in which you choose to spend your free time. All these choices reflect your values. If you want to change the world, you can do so by making the way you live reflect the values you hold dear.

Everywhere in the world, people are exploring the issues and then making choices to improve their communities.

- They do it by making personal choices, like choosing to write on recycled paper or speaking their first language at home.
- They do it through organizations, such as by joining a planning committee for a White Ribbon campaign.
- They do it through work, perhaps by supporting and respecting their co-workers.
- They do it through government, too, perhaps by handing out leaflets for a political party with policies that would benefit the community.

Every person in the world makes choices. Will the choices you make benefit and build your community and, by extension, your world?

Figure 21-1 Here are four ways in which people demonstrate their **global citizenship** to address the challenges and opportunities of globalization. Think of one possible strategy you might adopt at each level. In the Skill Path for this chapter, you will have the opportunity to evaluate one such strategy in writing.

Chapter Issue

In this chapter, you will consider the Chapter Issue: *What are the most effective strategies I could use to demonstrate responsible global citizenship?* To begin your exploration, you will investigate a few of the many means for responding to globalization through organizations, governments, and business. You will evaluate some of them to decide whether they are effective. In the last section, you will get a chance to test one way of putting your responsible citizenship into action.

Reading Guide

Collecting information as you read can help spark ideas. As you read this chapter, build a list of ways that people can get involved as active global citizens. Include suggestions given in the chapter as well as ideas that cross your mind as you read.

Taking Action through Organizations

Question for Inquiry

- **How can individuals and organizations respond to globalization?**

What are the most effective strategies I could use to demonstrate responsible global citizenship? To begin considering this Chapter Issue, you can investigate how other people exercise their powers of global citizenship. People have many ways to express and act on their values, both individually and collectively, through organizations, businesses, and government. In this section, you will have a chance to focus on action through organizations. Through coordinated effort, individual citizens can work informally with others to increase their influence, or they can work directly for formal organizations that address global problems.

boycott an organized campaign in which consumers refuse to purchase goods or services from a business or country because they disagree with its policies

Consumer Activism

What critical thinking goes into your purchasing decisions? Do you go for the best buy? The best service? The best product? What about the business or country you're buying from? Do you ask whether it has a good human rights record? Does it have a history of banning child labour? Become informed. Then, you can use your consumer power. For example, you and six friends could withhold your "dollar votes" from companies that employ children. This is a **boycott**.

Do you think individuals' boycotts are effective? Imagine if 100 000 people participated in your boycott instead of seven teenagers: would you predict a better result? Organization is one key to coordinating consumer action and making it effective.

Figure 21-2 Cindy Espindola (left), 10, holds a sign to express her opinion about immigrants' rights during "A Day without Immigrants" in San Diego, California, in May 2006. Politicians were debating whether or not to restrict immigration. What point is Espindola making? Immigrants and other protesters boycotted school, work, and making purchases. How could a demonstration influence the effectiveness of a boycott like this?

Voices

Would a "Buy Canadian" Buycott Work Today?

Boycotts and **buycotts** are potent tools for expressing your opinion in today's marketplace. The following article shows one point of view about the potential effectiveness of a "Buy Canadian" buycott in today's marketplace. The writer is Lee Morrison, former Alliance MP for Cypress Hills–Grasslands in Saskatchewan. (The Canadian Alliance was one of the forerunners of the Conservative Party of Canada.) As you read, jot down reasons you might agree or disagree with his opinion.

buycott an organized campaign in which consumers purposely purchase from a company to show that they agree with its corporate policies

You can learn a lot at a Wal-Mart. I recently visited the kitchenware and small appliances section of a mid-sized Wal-Mart, checking labels for country of origin.

Of 25 randomly selected items, 17 were from China, three each from Mexico and the US, and one each from Italy and Thailand. Absolutely nothing was marked "Made in Canada." The Chinese products all carried familiar brand names (Sunbeam, Proctor-Silex, GE, etc.).

Extending my little informal survey to three more chain stores (Future Shop, Canadian Tire, and Sears), I found Wal-Mart isn't the only purveyor [seller] of mostly Chinese goods.

Of 100 items in four stores, 54 were made in China. Only three things—some children's clothing and a package of shoddy screwdrivers—were made in Canada. Most of the remainder came from cheap-labour countries.

Not many years ago, as part of a federal "buy Canadian" promotion, Canadian products were marked by a Maple Leaf logo. Today, such a campaign would be impossible because there is almost nothing on which to put the labels.

With most consumer goods already being manufactured in overseas sweatshops, Canadian workers eagerly lining up to buy $15 shirts and $25 toasters are aiding and abetting [encouraging] the destruction of their own manufacturing jobs while they scramble for service industry employment at survival-level wages.

Source: Lee Morrison, "Made in China Leaves Us Behind," *Calgary Herald*, December 15, 2005.

1. In a small group, discuss this question: "Do you, as a Canadian citizen, have a responsibility to purchase Canadian products and services?"
2. A different question involves whether or not a "Buy Canadian" campaign would be an effective strategy. What is Lee Morrison's position on this? Draw from the article to support your answer.
3. Do you agree with Morrison's position about the potential effectiveness of a "Buy Canadian" buycott? Follow Step 4 of this chapter's Skill Path to put a position in writing. SKILL PATH
4. Will you change your buying habits as a result of answering the above three questions? Explain.

Active Citizen

Take action by starting some buzz about boycotting in your school. Survey students in your school to ask the five questions at right.

In a small group, tally your collective results and assess the potential effectiveness of boycotting power in your school based on the results of your survey. If things look promising, form a club with interested students to develop a schoolwide boycott effort.

Possible Survey Questions

1. Do you "buy Canadian"?
2. Would you do so in an organized buycott?
3. Do you avoid purchasing products made in countries that employ child labour?
4. Would you do so in an organized boycott?
5. What type of issue would inspire you to take part in a boycott?

The Efficiency of Formal Organization

So far in this chapter, you have considered the extent to which individual action may have more effect if many people coordinate their efforts. Coordination may influence the potential effectiveness of everything from boycotts to recycling programs, and from activist protest to environmental clean-up days in your community. Some tasks, however, can be even better coordinated through formal organizations.

Voices

One Albertan Making a Difference

Dr. Jenn Brenner began volunteering in Uganda through the Canadian International Development Agency (CIDA). At that time, one in five children in the Mbarara District were dying of preventable diseases such as malaria and diarrhea. By working through CIDA, Dr. Brenner is in the process of helping Ugandans solve that problem.

It began with the help of doctors at Mbarara University of Science and Technology in Uganda, the University of Calgary, and the Canadian Paediatric Society. With their help, Dr. Brenner has established a low-cost program that is saving children's lives. People have had many different experiences with overseas volunteer placements. Here, Dr. Brenner describes hers.

Figure 21-3 Dr. Jenn Brenner volunteers with CIDA in Uganda. Through this organization, she is helping to build a "human ambulance" network to save the lives of children.

The core of the program is a network of 117 community volunteers who have been trained in basic child health promotion and how to recognize when children can be treated at home or when they need to go to a hospital, often many kilometres away.

The volunteers—70 per cent women, all parents of young children—are chosen by the communities themselves. After an initial three-day training program, they meet once a month for refresher courses.

[They] visit homes, talk to pregnant mothers, give demonstrations and help get people out for the twice-yearly Child Health Days, where on average 500 children get weighed and immunized. They're like human ambulances, bringing very ill children to the hospital and helping families get the care they need.

What they lack in formal education, they make up for in motivation and commitment. They will walk five to 10 kilometres just to attend a meeting.

It's a Ugandan project with Canadian support. We think too many children are dying. They think too many children are dying. And they're doing something about it.

Source: http://www.acdi-cida.gc.ca/CIDAWEB/acdicida.nsf/En/REN-218124248-NSC.

Web Link

Find out about other volunteers' experiences with CIDA. Follow the suggested links at the *Living in a Globalizing World* website.

1. Within a few years, the project aims to reach more than 20 000 Ugandan children. Could Dr. Brenner have done this on her own? How have global connections among organizations and among people made this project possible?
2. Use the analysis questions in Step 3 in the Skill Path for this chapter to help you evaluate the strategy of this project. Is it a strategy that you would support? SKILL PATH

FastFacts

On September 8, 2000, the United Nations issued the Millennium Declaration, a statement that laid out eight Millennium Development Goals (MDGs) to solve world problems. (See page 278.) For what reasons might organizations set goals? How does setting a goal help get things done?

Web Link

Want to accomplish something on your summer break? Memorial University provides a list of organizations that can help arrange a volunteer vacation for you. Just follow the suggested links at the *Living in a Globalizing World* website.

Consider, for example, the case of a volcanic explosion in Indonesia. Suppose that you and two of your friends decided to dedicate six months of your lives to assisting the people who lost their homes. How much would you accomplish by getting on a plane and travelling to Indonesia without any planning or support? On the other hand, think about how much the three of you could accomplish if you contacted the organizations involved in handling the emergency. An organization could advise you on how to prepare. It could provide the introductions and placement that would allow you to make a real difference in someone's life or the life of a community. Read the Voices feature on the previous page to consider the case of one Albertan who connected with an organization to volunteer in Uganda.

Organizations offer many opportunities for involvement, not just volunteerism. For example, you might decide to donate money to an organization that could address global issues on your behalf. Or, you could take courses that would enable you to gain employment with such an organization.

Explore the Issues

1. ***Be a Critical Consumer.*** A 2005 Decimas Corporate Vision Nationwide survey found that Canadian consumers tend to use four criteria to decide where to give their business:
   - Excellent customer service (36%)
   - Excellent-quality products (30%)
   - Ethics/integrity/honesty (19%)
   - Treatment of employees (17%)

   a) In a team of four students, discuss the following questions:
   - Which of the above criteria are related to protecting self-interest?
   - Which are related to being a responsible citizen?
   - Identify one other criterion that you believe would address an important challenge of globalization.

   b) To see how you might begin influencing companies with your buying power, try the following strategy for putting some thought into how you spend your money:
   - With your team, rank the five criteria in order of importance to you.
   - Assign a weighting of "5" to your top choice, "4" to your second choice, and so on.
   - Develop a list of your team's 10 favourite companies or stores.
   - Rank the stores from 10 to 1 for each criterion, with 10 being the best.
   - For each criterion, multiply the rank by the weighting. You will have a chart like the one begun below.

Company/ Business	Top Criterion (x5)	2nd Criterion (x4)	3rd Criterion (x3)	4th Criterion (x2)	5th Criterion (x1)	Total
Samir's Bakery	3x5=15	7x4=28	4x3=12	3x2=6	3x1=3	44

   c) To what degree will your work on this activity influence your buying habits? Explain.

2. ***Compare Benefits and Drawbacks.*** Develop an organizer to compare the benefits and drawbacks of individual action and collective action as a means for responding to globalization as a responsible global citizen.

SP Critical Thinking

Defend a Position in Writing

SKILL PATH

When you explore an issue, you make inquiries and then formulate a position. In the project for Part 1 (pages 102–103), you learned how to put together a position. Now you can learn how to put your position into writing. You could apply this skill to writing pieces such as a position paragraph, a letter to the editor, notes for a debate, or a radio commentary.

Your Task: To explore the Chapter Issue for this chapter, you will need to evaluate a number of strategies for addressing the challenges and opportunities related to globalization. In this Skill Path, you will research and evaluate just *one* such strategy. You will state your position in writing to explain whether or not you found the strategy to be effective, and why. After hearing other students' assessments of other strategies, you can better decide which strategies you might employ to demonstrate your responsible global citizenship.

Why Word Processing?
Word-processing software programs make it easy to create, edit, and revise written compositions, including reports, essays, and journals. Many programs help you set up headings and subheadings, insert text boxes, and import photographs.

Step 1

Identify a Strategy to Evaluate

Select an organization that interests you. Here are a few possibilities:

- Amnesty International
- Activists for Animals
- EarthYouth.NET
- Free the Children
- Association canadienne-française de l'Alberta
- Native Women's Council of Canada
- Médecins Sans Frontières (Doctors Without Borders)
- Inter Pares

Each of these has its own website where you can start your research. Visit a few of these sites and identify one strategy. Here are a few possible strategies:

- providing emergency food or medical aid
- supplying tools such as farming equipment
- sending teachers to help local inhabitants develop their skills
- funding local organizations to make it possible for them to solve problems
- lobbying for social change

Refer to the Skill Path for Chapter 19 (page 315) to review how to make a good decision.

Step 2

Research Your Chosen Strategy

Research your chosen strategy further to find out how at least one other organization uses it. Visit your school and public libraries and computer network to discover what they can offer. Assess your research materials for bias by applying the steps of the Skill Path for Chapter 2 (pages 23–24).

Step 3

Evaluate It

To evaluate your chosen strategy, use some of the following questions to help you identify criteria for your evaluation. Explain your choices of criteria and your answers to the questions.

- Does your strategy help resolve problems related to globalization?
- Who uses this strategy?
- Does it address an immediate need or help address a long-term problem?
- Does it fix a symptom or a cause of a problem?
- How is it effective?
- Does it reflect the values of the people involved?
- Does it reflect your values?

Develop a persuasive position outline as you did in the project for Part 1 on pages 102–103.

Fostering Children

More people should sponsor children through a charitable organization. This is a good strategy because it doesn't take much time or effort, but it helps children get an education. For example, you could sponsor a child through World Vision for just $30 per month—just $1 per day. That pays for things like tuition, school supplies, and checkups at a health clinic. On the other hand, you might not want to donate through World Vision because it is a Christian organization. If you were an atheist, for example, or belonged to a different religious organization, you might be more comfortable with Foster Parents Plan, which is not affiliated with any religious organization. Both organizations, though, could help you make a difference in a young person's life.

Evaluate this sample paragraph, which gives one student's position. Which of the questions posed in Step 3 does it answer? Does the paragraph follow the general structure in Step 4?

Job Link

In the future, many Canadians, like you, will find a job in the growing knowledge industries. The jobs in these industries tend to require high literacy levels and a sound ability to present your case in writing. For example, most working people in these industries communicate and solve problems via email. That's why learning skills like the one in this Skill Path will take you places in life.

Step 4

Put Your Position in Writing

If possible, use word-processing technology to write your first draft.

1. First sentence: State your position, that is, how effective the strategy is.
2. Second sentence: Explain why you hold that position.
3. Middle sentences: To support your position, give examples of organizations that have used this strategy effectively or not.
4. Last sentence: Restate your position as a conclusion.

You can see an example of a position paragraph at left.

Step 5

Editing

Get a teacher or friend to read your first draft. Reword phrases to make sure that all sentences make sense. Improve the organization of your ideas. Is there content that needs to be added or clarified?

Step 6

Sharing

Present your finished document to your teacher in hard copy or electronically. Each student can read aloud his or her composition to the class.

Step 7

Reflecting on the Process

Consider your work. Evaluate your written composition.

- Did it present your informed position?
- Did you evaluate information from both print and electronic sources?
- After hearing others' paragraphs, how would you change yours?
- Why is it important to consider your own values when choosing a strategy to support?
- Why might it be important to research a variety of perspectives on a strategy or organization before taking action yourself?
- How has what you learned affected what strategy you might like to use to respond to globalization?

Taking Action through Government

Question for Inquiry

- **How can individuals and government respond to globalization?**

At the age of 12, Severn-Cullis Suzuki raised funds and attended the 1992 Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. She made a speech that caught the attention of government delegates from around the world. The London protesters of 2005 were also heard. Compare and contrast these two strategies for influencing government.

"Speech at the Earth Summit"

By Severn Cullis-Suzuki

"I'm only a child and I don't have all the solutions, but I want you to realize neither do you. … If you don't know how to fix it, then please stop breaking it."

Speech at the Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro, 1992

Montreal Demo Centrepiece of Global Warming Protests

By Dan Beaulieu

In London, protesters passed 10 Downing Street, home of Prime Minister Tony Blair, where they presented a letter demanding that the government reaffirm its commitment to Kyoto. … Jennifer Morgan, International Director of the World Wildlife Fund's Climate Change Program, urged politicians to "listen to these tens of thousands of people."

Canadian Press, December 4, 2005

Perhaps the largest organization with a mission to represent the views of citizens is government. Taxpayers fund their local, provincial, and federal levels of government to meet the needs of all citizens and address their concerns. In this section, you will explore ways that you can demonstrate responsible global citizenship through government.

petition a written request signed by many people appealing to an authority or government for change

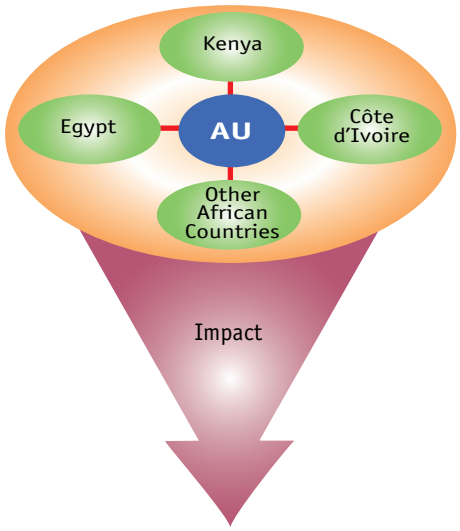
Getting Involved

Every few years, Canadians have the opportunity to vote for a political party that will best represent their interests. Voting, however, is just the most basic of ways that Canadians can influence governments. For example, though you are not yet of voting age, you still have the right to participate in politics. You can join the youth wing of a political party, participate in political conventions, and campaign for the candidate of your choice.

In addition, you have the power to pressure political representatives to act responsibly. That is what Cullis-Suzuki was doing at the Rio Summit in the quotation above. As an individual or as the member of an organization, you have the power to persuade your political representatives by force of numbers and headlines rather than by physical force. This power can be applied effectively to push specific issues up the political agenda. You can write letters, send emails, and sign **petitions.** For example, in 2005, a group of citizens in the United Kingdom petitioned their own government to ban the import of Canadian seal products into the United Kingdom because they opposed the seal hunt. People in another 29 countries also staged protests. By 2007, protesters began to see results when Belgium banned the import of all seal products.

Ultimately, you can influence government by working for change as a civil servant (government employee), by running for election yourself or by influencing your government representatives.

Figure 21-4 Student Gabrielle Bérard makes a speech in her role as Premier of Nova Scotia in a "First Ministers' Meeting" at a Forum for Young Canadians in Ottawa, 2002. Why might young people like Bérard take part in political events? What factors would inspire you to join the youth wing of a political party?



African countries banded together to form the African Union (AU). Use this diagram to explain how working together might help African countries reach the AU goal of increased peace, security, and stability within Africa.

Responsibilities of Governments

In what ways can governments act to address global issues? First, they have the responsibility to make laws to solve problems. For example, the Supreme Court of Canada ruled in 1990 (Mahe v. The Queen) that the Alberta School Act violated section 23 of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms. This—as well as petitions and other forms of pressure from Franco-Albertans—forced the Alberta government to use its power to make laws. It brought in legislation to amend the School Act in 1988. This action made sure that the Alberta school system recognized the rights of the minority Francophone population to govern its schools through Francophone school boards. It also addressed a global issue—the recognition of minority rights—at a regional level.

Second, governments have the responsibility to assign funds directly to projects to address inequities overseas. For example, they help fund CIDA, which you read about earlier in this chapter.

Thirdly, governments can pressure other governments. For example, many governments stopped trading with South Africa during its apartheid years (the period in that country when people of different ethnic backgrounds were not considered equal before the law). This pressure helped convince the South African government to change.

Finally, governments can also enter into and participate in inter-governmental organizations (IGOs) that undertake to resolve certain global issues. In some cases, international agreements are involved. IGOs work to preserve and protect species and ecosystems, take action to strengthen peace and security, and encourage development of a healthy global economy. By joining IGOs, countries attempt to meet their common political, economic, social, and cultural goals.

Figure 21-5 Examples of intergovernmental organizations. Consider just one of these agencies: the OIC consists of 56 Islamic countries that "pool their resources together, combine their efforts, and speak with one voice to safeguard the interest and ensure the progress and well-being of their peoples" (OIC website). Speculate on what each of the other organizations attempts to do.

Political Organizations	Economic Organizations	Cultural Organizations
• European Union (EU) • Organization of American States (OAS) • Assembly of First Nations (AFN)	• Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) • Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC)	• Council of Europe (CE) • Organization of the Islamic Conference (OIC) • Alberta Native Friendship Centres Association (ANFCA)

Web Link

For more information about the AIDS drug crisis, follow the links at the *Living in a Globalizing World* website.

A Pledge to Africa

Government can have good intentions, but are government strategies always effective at solving problems?

Think about what is happening in the area of HIV/AIDS drugs. As you learned in Chapter 19, a majority of the people who die from AIDS live in Africa. They die because they cannot afford to pay for medicine.

To make medicines more affordable in less developed countries, the World Trade Organization advocated "access to medicine for all" in 2001. It encouraged governments to relax their drug laws to allow companies to get generic drugs to people in less developed countries.

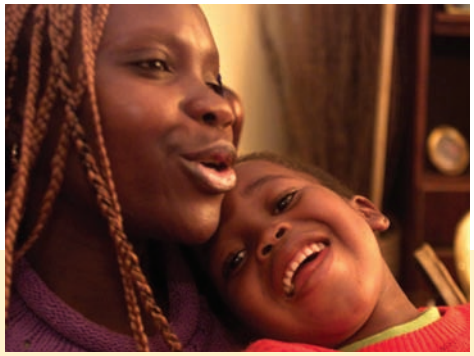
Four years later, on May 14, 2005, the Canadian government passed a law called the Jean Chrétien Pledge to Africa Act (JCPA). According to this law, generic pharmaceutical companies would sell generic medicines at low prices to countries that cannot afford the usual high prices of patented drugs.

Did it work? As of May 2006, no drug had yet reached a less developed country under this law. Why not? According to Médecins Sans Frontières (Doctors Without Borders), there are several reasons:

- The legislation is complex, and many steps must be taken before a drug can be exported.
- Health Canada must approve the drug (unlike the case of all other exported drugs).
- The legislation restricts the types of medicines that can be approved.

How effective was government legislation in addressing this challenge of globalization? In 2007, the government will review its law. What would you recommend to make this strategy more workable?

Figure 21-6 By receiving certain medications just before giving birth, a mother can avoid passing on HIV/AIDS to her newborn child. Ingrid Keolotswe, shown here in 2003, did not have access to those drugs when she gave birth to her son, Onilegape. What might you do to improve the chances of your government's putting into place effective strategies for addressing problems like this?



Explore the Issues

1. ***Evaluate and Promote.*** Research local government initiatives designed to enable citizens to take active responsibility to address a community issue, such as feeding the hungry or providing shelter for the homeless. Choose one initiative that you decide is effective. Use Step 3 of the Skill Path in this chapter to help your evaluation. Create a web page or poster to get more people involved. SKILL PATH

2. ***Discuss and Evaluate***
   - **a)** Are governments effective vehicles for responding to global citizenship?
   - **b)** Identify three strategies that governments can use to meet their civic responsibilities and respond to globalization.
   - **c)** Develop a set of criteria to evaluate them.
   - **d)** Evaluate and rank the three strategies.

Taking Action through Business

Question for Inquiry

- **How can individuals and business respond to globalization?**

In the corporate world, everyone knows the "bottom line": make a profit for your shareholders or you will go out of business. While this may be true, another position holds that corporations do have civic responsibilities to society at large, because it is society that grants them the licence to operate. What are the right strategies for achieving that goal? In this section, you will have a chance to think about how corporations could respond to globalization. You will also have a chance to think about what opportunities the corporate world might offer you for demonstrating your responsible global citizenship.

ethical consistent with agreed principles of moral conduct

Business versus Civic Responsibilities: A Conflict?

When it comes to the world of money, businesses do not always operate **ethically**. Competition drives many companies to pay low wages, ignore safety or health problems, or ignore the environmental problems their business practices create. Some companies operate as if "anything goes." Others pretend to operate ethically in order to attract more customers. Some, however, choose strategies that they hope will fulfill both their duty to make a profit and their civic responsibilities as global citizens. In the Global Connections feature on page 355, you will have the chance to evaluate the behaviour of three companies.

Figure 21-7 This photograph shows a person dropping a container into a recycling bin provided by The Body Shop. Which comes first, a company's desire to benefit society, or its desire to increase business? Does it matter? Explain your thoughts about corporate ethical behaviour.

Voices

Strategies for Fulfilling Ethical Obligations

The two writers here are making two different points about which strategies for fulfilling a company's civic responsibilities are possible, effective, or necessary.

It may be that simply carrying on reasonably effective business in a generally transparent manner is about the most that any decent group of people called businesspeople can be expected to accomplish. In most of the places we are … talking about, this is heroic challenge enough.

Source: Lionel Tiger, Rutgers University, "The Smell Test Still Works," 2006.

In another case, a lecturer pointed out a problem to oil company executives in Angola: they were creating a huge gap between the lives and work of oil company workers and those of Angolan locals. Charles Handy describes what happened.

The executives were indignant, defensive, and angry. They were creating wealth, after all, they said. Yes, replied my friend, but in the process they were mangling the environment and creating rifts [chasms] in the surrounding society, disturbing old ways and values and taking away much of their irreplaceable asset [oil].

"What are we supposed to do?" asked the executives.

"Don't ask me," [the lecturer] replied. "Ask the Angolans."

Source: Charles Handy, "Creating Wealth Is Not Enough," The Conference Board Review, January/February 2002, p. 21.

1. Complete the following sentence twice, each time as one of the speakers in this feature. "The most effective strategy that business could use to demonstrate civic responsibility is … because … ."
2. How would you personally complete the sentence? To do so, first consider what you personally believe are the civic responsibilites of businesses to the citizens in the countries in which they operate. Then think about the best strategies.

Global Connections

Doing Business in China's Industrial Zones

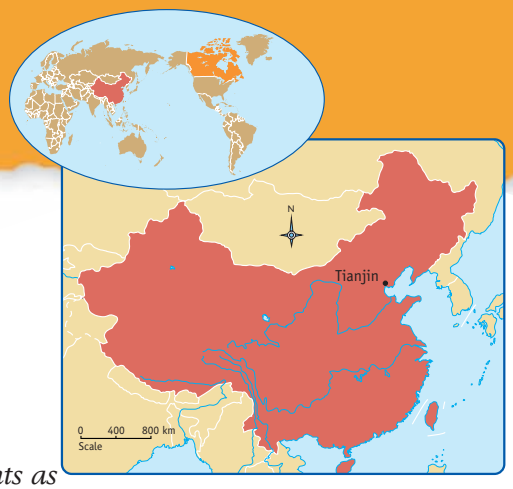


Figure 21-8 Bao's factory is located in the Rongcheng Industry Zone, near Tianjin, the largest manufacturing port in China.

Journalist Bill McKibben visited China in 2005 to investigate the country's growing manufacturing sector. He visited a shower-curtain plant owned by Bao Jijun. Here are some facts about the factory:

- Number of employees: 100
- Ages of employees: 18–24 years
- Average salary: 1000 yuan a month (about 100 dollars)
- Length of workday: 8 hours
- Cost of lunch (soup) in the cafeteria: 1.7 yuan (20 cents)
- Sleeping quarters: dormitories with bunk beds—six workers to a room
- Recreation table: a shared television set and ping-pong table

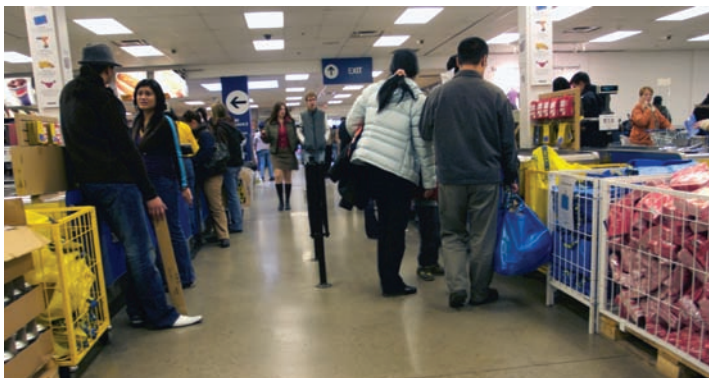
As you read the following excerpt from McKibben's article, think about who is fulfilling a corporate responsibility, and what strategies they are using to accomplish that goal.

One reason [Bao's] factory is decent is because he's a good guy. Another is that he sells some of his shower curtains to Ikea. The company sends an inspector, unannounced, several times a year to check on the living spaces and the number of toilets and so on, and slowly these inspectors have been checking off the improvements. "It adds to the cost, but I appreciate it. I regard the requirements as help to reach the level of a factory in a developed county," Bao says with a kind of Rotarian [civic] pride.

Depending on the model, Bao can make a shower curtain for about 21 yuan [Chinese dollars]. He can sell one for about 24 yuan. When you buy a similar shower curtain in a [North] American big-box store it retails for about $30, or about 240 yuan. But Bao doesn't do much business directly with American-owned retailers. When a pair of buyers from the States came to visit a few months earlier, they had told him they could sell millions of curtains. But he would somehow have to drive the price down to 18 yuan. Which would mean, say, getting rid of the ping-pong table, or adding a few hours to the workday, or doubling the price of the soup.

Source: Bill McKibben, "The Great Leap," *Harper's Magazine*, December 2005, p. 45. Copyright © 2005 by Harper's Magazine. All rights reserved. Reproduced from the December issue by special permission.

Figure 21-9 Inside an Ikea store in North York, 2006. Ikea's slogan is "Low Price, But Not at Any Price." Explain what you think the company is trying to get across with this statement. In what ways could such a policy affect a company's "bottom line"? Does such a policy affect your desire to buy from the company?



FastFacts

In 1916, Ford Motor Company had a large surplus. Henry Ford wanted to lower the price of his cars and employ more people. The courts disagreed. Ford was forced to send the profits to shareholders. This ruling led to laws making it a standard business practice in Western countries that a company's prime duty was to make money for shareholders.

How might this duty affect a company's choice of strategy for meeting its civic responsibility?

1. How much does it cost Bao to produce a shower curtain? How much were the buyers from the United States willing to pay?
2. In the above excerpt, you see the actions of three businesses: the Chinese-owned factory, the American-owned retailers, and Swedish-owned Ikea.
   a) Describe the corporate behaviour of each.
   b) To what degree does each company seem concerned with its responsibilities to shareholders or owners?
   c) To what degree does each seem concerned with civic responsibilities?
   d) Which of these three businesses would you prefer to work for? Why?
   e) For the other two businesses, how would you recommend that they change their corporate behaviour to attract workers like you?

Explore the Issues

1. ***Think of the Possibilities.*** Identify three strategies that you could use in your future career to demonstrate responsible global citizenship by influencing the decisions that businesses make. Use the following sentence structure: "If I become a ___ I could …" and "I chose this strategy because … ."
2. ***Evaluate.*** Based on what you have read so far in this chapter and in this textbook, select four means for responding to globalization. Rate them based on a set of criteria that you develop with your class. Give a weighting to each criterion based on its importance in your evaluation. Follow the example in Activity 1 on page 348.

Connecting with Your Citizenship

Question for Inquiry

- **How can I begin to respond to globalization?**

Here is one point of view about the nature of citizenship. ("Provocative" words would be those spoken to make listeners angry.) How would you end the sentence beginning with, "The essence of citizenship is …"?

> "The essence of citizenship is to be tolerant of strong and provocative words."
>
> Source: *Prime Minister John Diefenbaker, April 9, 1970, House of Commons.*

You can probably rhyme off the markers of citizenship: it means you have a right to a Canadian passport, which identifies you to the world as a Canadian. It means obeying Canadian laws, rules, and regulations. It means being aware of political events and voting in elections and referenda.

Beyond these skeleton markers are further understandings of citizenship—what citizenship means to you personally. In this section, you will explore different perspectives about the meaning of citizenship. You will have a chance to try out being a responsible global citizen. With your class, you will test one strategy for calling attention to a challenge or opportunity of globalization in your community. You will evaluate its effectiveness. These inquiries will help you address the Chapter Issue: ***What are the most effective strategies I could use to demonstrate responsible global citizenship?***

Exploring Understandings of Citizenship

Citizenship is about who you are as a member of a society. Your understanding of it may involve your sense of identity, your rights, your roles as a member of multiple communities, or your spirit of involvement. For many people, citizenship is about being active and engaged.

For minorities, action may be necessary for the survival of the community. Consider the example of the Franco-Albertans. In 1982, the education rights of both official-language minorities were enshrined in the Canadian Constitution. Were Franco-Albertans able to exercise those rights immediately? No. First, they worked hard to help the provincial government and school boards understand the rights. Then they convinced two school boards to establish a school in their respective jurisdictions in 1984. They also went to the Supreme Court to confirm their right to run Francophone school boards. Fighting for and exercising their constitutional rights has given Franco-Albertans the opportunity to understand citizenship more fully in Canada.

Globalization has provided you with challenges and opportunities, roles and responsibilities, not only to participate in the world that exists in the first decade of the 21st century but also to contribute toward improving it. Must you begin by getting involved in major international efforts to solve global problems? No. You can begin by becoming aware, or by engaging in international or local issues.

Here are just a few ways to become a more engaged, responsible citizen. What imaginative strategy would you suggest? Which one could you picture yourself taking up?

- Attend a cultural, political, or social event sponsored by a minority linguistic or cultural group.
- Ask seniors about local history.
- Write a letter to the editor about something you feel passionate about.
- Volunteer at a senior-citizen nutrition centre.
- Get involved with the student council.
- Donate money to a worthy cause.

Beginning with Discovery

Global citizenship begins with discovery, with becoming aware of the experiences of individuals in various communities, including your own. You can explore their understandings by listening to their stories. For example, by exploring the narratives in the following Voices feature, you can develop understandings of citizenship issues.

Voices

Thoughts about Citizenship

Here are three young Canadians' thoughts about citizenship. What citizenship issues interest each of them?

My challenge is to strike a balance between the best of both worlds—to perpetuate those aspects of my Kenyan culture that I value, and to assimilate [internalize] those attitudes and customs that allow me to successfully integrate as a new Canadian. I have to make a conscious effort to march boldly into Canadian society while preserving the ideals and cultural heritage I hold dear.

Source: Anthony Oyieke, Montréal, Québec, 2005.

Figure 21-10 Anthony Oyieke.

World issues today are so huge and complex that people my age are shutting down and going into emotional survival mode . . . . This apathetic attitude is lethal [deadly] for a healthy democratic society. When people cease to see the point of voting or taking part in civic life, they cease to see the point of being active, caring citizens.

Source: Caitlin Brubacher, aged 22, Montréal, Québec, 2005.

Figure 21-11 Caitlin Brubacher.

I am a Canadian and an advocate [supporter] for social justice and diversity, but my residency in the Treaty Six area and in Saskatchewan's Waterhen Lake Cree First Nation is what defines me most strongly. Participation in these territories is not subordinate [second] to my Canadian citizenship but an integral [interwoven] part of it.

Source: Gordon Martell, 40, Saskatoon, Saskatchewan, 2005.

Figure 21-12 Gordon Martell with his grandfather, Bruno Martell, at the celebration of Bruno's 89th birthday at Waterhen Lake, 1989.

1. What does Brubacher see as the cause of the "apathetic attitude" that she observes among some young people in her generation? Have you seen this attitude among your peers? What solution do you propose to apathy?
2. Which idea about citizenship expressed here speaks to you most strongly? Explain.
3. In this chapter, you are considering how you might become a more responsible global citizen. In your efforts, how important is it to investigate first and act second? Why? How does exploring a variety of perspectives help you better understand an issue?

Petitioning for Change

By taking this course of study, you have taken a step in informing yourself about issues related to globalization. What do you do next? Taking direct action by volunteering your time is one route. Donating funds is another. An equally legitimate "next step" could be to influence the people who have the power to address your concerns. For example, you might lobby a business group, an organization, or one of the three levels of government. This would be the action of a responsible global citizen.

You now have an opportunity to try out one strategy for effecting change by planning, preparing, and presenting a petition.

READING GUIDE

For a major group activity like this petition, begin by reading aloud the whole activity. Students can take turns reading the steps. This gives you the big picture before you get started. Then you can go back and discuss each step one by one.

Think About the Issues

With a partner, collect articles from local newspapers that reveal issues of concern to local citizens. Watch for articles that involve town or city councilors, your mayor, or a public service department. All topics should relate to globalization. For each article, write a brief statement explaining how the issue raised by the article affects your life.

Select one issue of interest to you and your partner. It could involve an issue or problem that has already been considered in this program of study.

Plan Your Position

Research and write a brief position paragraph to recommend a public policy change to address your chosen issue. The paragraph will appear at the head of your petition. Be clear and concise. People will be reading this paragraph as they decide whether or not to sign your petition. SKILL PATH

Figure 21-13 A Saskatchewan student signs a petition encouraging support of the Kyoto Protocol. Is a petition an effective tool for change?

Present and Decide

Read your position paragraphs in class. Then, as a class, select one public policy change that a majority of students would like to support.

Prepare Your Class Petition

As a class, assign volunteer teams to take on the following duties

- Obtain permission to seek signatures on school property.
- Design the petition to look professional. Put the position paragraph at the top. Leave many blank lines underneath for signatures.
- Photocopy enough copies of the petition for all students in the class.
- Plan places and times when class members can try to get signatures. Plan for a one- to three-day "blitz."
- Plan an information table in the hallway or school cafeteria, where other students can find out more about your petition.
- Make posters or advertise your campaign in other ways.
- Post the petition on your school's website, with information about where people can sign the petition.

Conduct the Petition

Conduct your petition. Do not pressure or bribe people to sign. Make sure they understand the petition before they sign.

Plan Your Follow-up

- Develop a list of elected officials to whom you would like to send your collected signatures. These might include your alderperson, school trustee, mayor, MLA, and premier, for example. Identify officials who would have the power to make the changes you want.
- Arrange to deliver your petition in person, if possible.
- Contact your local community television or radio station. Invite them to attend when you deliver your petition.

Explore the Issues

1. ***Compare.*** In the first three sections of this chapter, you were engaged in the strategy of becoming informed. In this section, you tried a strategy for taking action. Which strategy was more satisfying? Explain. In what ways were they effective (or not) for expressing your active, responsible citizenship?

2. ***Plan and Predict.*** Consider this statement: "The best way to change the world is to change yourself."
   - **a)** Do you agree with this statement? Explain.
   - **b)** Choose one change you might make that would, in a small way, change the world. Write a short story in which your small action snowballs into global change.

Chapter Summary and Reflection

Apply and Extend Ideas

1. ***Plan and Execute.*** Plan a bingo game to review key terms.
   - **a)** With a team, design bingo cards with key terms from chapters in Part 4. Make enough cards for everyone in your class.
   - **b)** Write down all the definitions in a list.
   - **c)** One person calls out the definitions of these key terms while students in your class put markers on their cards if they know the key term being defined and have it on their card.
   - **d)** When one line is completely filled, the student yells "Bingo!" and recites his or her list of terms to ensure they coincide with the definitions.
   - **e)** To win, the student must also give an example of one of the five key terms.

2. ***Consider Multiple Perspectives.*** Flip through Part 4 of this textbook and jot down five topics or case studies that provide opportunities for controversy. You might choose anything from biotechnology to the Kyoto Protocol. All topics should relate to globalization. Keep in mind that what you read about in this book can include only some of the possible perspectives on these topics. There will always be more!
   - **a)** Choose one topic that sparks your interest. Set a timer for 10 minutes and write down your point of view about it. Explain if and how you think you should take action.
   - **b)** Set your timer for five minutes and write about the same topic from a different group's perspective or person's point of view. Imagine that person is responding to your position. Explain whether that person thinks you should take action as you have suggested.
   - **c)** Repeat this exercise using four different points of view or perspectives.
   - **d)** Perspectives and points of view are not static—they change when people learn new

information or consider the views of others. Go back to your original written point of view. Would you revise it? If so, explain how and why.

e) How should considering multiple perspectives help you respond to the Chapter Issue: ***What are the most effective strategies I could use to demonstrate responsible global citizenship?***

3 ***Observe and Discuss.*** In class, brainstorm a list of the ways in which individuals can respond to globalization by being organized, and by influencing or being involved in organizations, businesses, and government. Using these examples, discuss this question: What are the benefits of acting for the common good of people worldwide?

4 ***Make Connections.*** What is the link between the choices that you make—socially, economically, and politically—and the future of our world? Put your position in writing. SKILL PATH

Practise Your Skill

5 ***Predict and Develop a Plan.***

a) Make a list of strategies you might consider using to personally address a problem caused by globalization, or to make use of an opportunity made possible by globalization. Consider strategies in the worlds of business, government, and organizations, as well as strategies in the way you live your life.

b) Evaluate the strategies. Would they be practical? Would they be effective?

c) Predict which strategy you will actually undertake, and explain why.

d) Develop a series of detailed steps that predict how you will make your goal a reality.

e) Draw an illustration that shows you carrying out your strategy.

f) Write a position paragraph to persuade an audience that your strategy is the right one for you. SKILL PATH

6 ***Make and Express a Decision.*** You have had many opportunities to think about the degree to which we should embrace globalization. Your opinion may have changed, depending on which aspects of globalization you were exploring. Exploration of important, broad issues can change people's opinions.

a) To help you develop a good response to the Key Issue for this course, create and fill in a chart like the one below.

Aspect of Globalization	Degree to Which We Should Embrace It (from 0 to 10)	Explanation

b) Now put your position in writing, using the skills you learned in the Skill Path for this chapter. SKILL PATH

c) How will what you have learned in this course affect the choices that you make in future? Evaluate the social, political, and economic aspects of your life.

Reflect on the Chapter Issue

You have evaluated several means by which individuals can respond to globalization through organizations, government, and business. You are now ready to respond to the Chapter Issue: ***What are the most effective strategies I could use to demonstrate responsible global citizenship?*** In class, read aloud the position paragraph you wrote for Activity 5. Persuade your classmates that the strategy you have chosen is the right one for you. After all students have presented their positions, take part of a class discussion about the Chapter Issue.

This exploration will help you to complete your development of a personal point of view about the Main Issue for Part 4: ***Should I, as a citizen, respond to globalization?***

Reflect on the Issues

During this course, you explored multiple perspectives about the various challenges and opportunities of globalization. You investigated the extent to which globalization affects your identity, leaves historical legacies, contributes to sustainable prosperity for all, and affects peoples lives. You are now ready to respond to the Key Issue: ***To what extent should we embrace globalization?*** Conduct a horseshoe debate following the steps in the Skill Path for Chapter 20 (page 328). Then choose a format of your choice to present your revised informed position on the Key Issue. As necessary, refer to the guidance on the inside back cover to develop your response. SKILL PATH